

Investment Banking

A Complete 4-Month Professional Course

A structured, practical, and industry-aligned program for early professionals, graduate students, and career-transition learners ready to break into one of finance's most competitive and rewarding fields.

4 MONTHS · 16 WEEKS · LIVE MENTORING · CAPSTONE PROJECT

Why This Course Matters

Investment Banking: The Gateway to Global Finance

Investment banking sits at the intersection of capital markets, corporate strategy, and financial analysis. It is one of the most sought-after and intellectually demanding careers in finance — and also one of the least accessible without the right foundation.

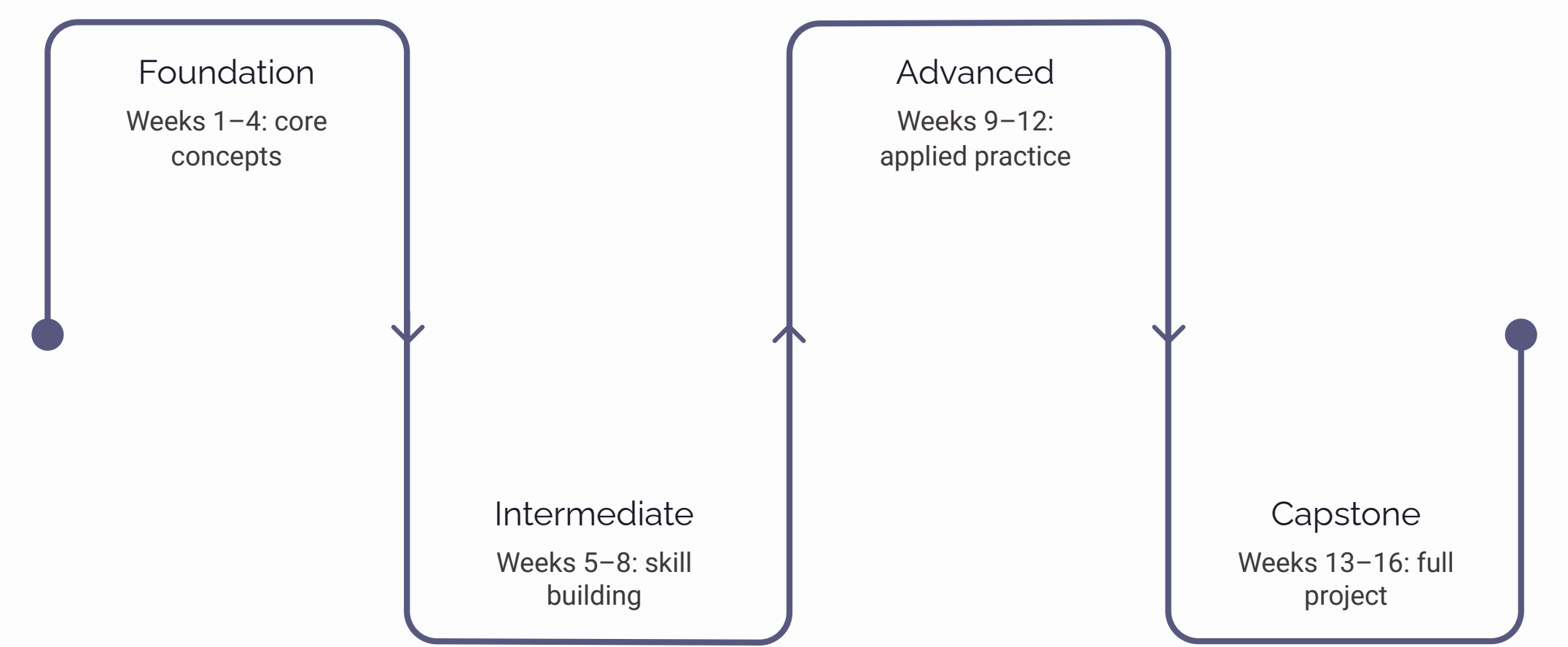
The Opportunity

- Global IB revenues exceed **\$300B annually**
- Demand for financial analysts growing 8% YoY
- Entry-level analysts earn \$100K–\$150K+ in top banks
- Direct exposure to M&A, IPOs, and capital raising

The Gap We're Closing

- Most programs are too theoretical or too advanced
- No structured bridge from grad school to the deal desk
- Excel, PowerPoint, and Bloomberg skills go untaught
- Real-world pitch books and models are rarely practiced

Course Architecture at a Glance



Each phase builds systematically on the previous one — ensuring learners move from conceptual clarity to real-world application. The program culminates in a full-scale capstone project that mirrors actual investment banking deliverables.

Weekend Sessions Recorded concept-focused lectures, case studies, and framework deep-dives available on-demand.	Live Mentoring Weekly 1:1 or small-group sessions for doubt clearing, model reviews, and career coaching.
Assignments Weekly deliverables — financial models, memos, and pitch decks — graded with detailed feedback.	Capstone A 3–4 week live deal simulation: full valuation, pitch book, and investor presentation.

Foundation Phase: The Language of Investment Banking

Before modeling deals or pitching clients, you must master the vocabulary, frameworks, and financial literacy that form the bedrock of every investment banker's toolkit. This phase builds fluency in finance fundamentals.

1

Week 1: IB Landscape & Career Pathways

- What is investment banking? Divisions and deal types
- Bulge bracket vs. boutique vs. middle market
- Analyst/Associate role expectations and day-in-the-life
- Key regulatory bodies: SEC, FINRA, FCA
- Overview of the deal lifecycle (origination → execution → close)
- Networking and breaking in: cold outreach, LinkedIn, alumni maps

2

Week 2: Accounting Foundations for Bankers

- The three financial statements and how they connect
- Revenue recognition, accruals, and GAAP vs. IFRS basics
- Reading an annual report (10-K) like a banker
- EBITDA, free cash flow, and working capital concepts
- Common accounting adjustments in IB models
- Mini exercise: Normalize financials for a real public company

3

Week 3: Corporate Finance Principles

- Time value of money: NPV, IRR, and WACC
- Capital structure: debt vs. equity tradeoffs
- Cost of capital and risk premiums
- Dividend policy and retained earnings
- Introduction to leverage and its impact on returns
- Case: Evaluate a company's capital structure decision

4

Week 4: Excel Mastery for Finance

- Excel shortcuts, formatting standards, and audit trails
- Financial functions: XIRR, XLOOKUP, INDEX/MATCH
- Building dynamic assumptions and scenario toggles
- Sensitivity tables and data tables in Excel
- Model structure best practices (color coding, checks)
- Assignment: Build a 3-statement model from scratch

What You'll Be Able to Do After Phase 1



Read Financial Statements

Interpret income statements, balance sheets, and cash flow statements for any public company — and identify red flags an analyst would catch.



Build a 3-Statement Model

Construct a fully linked financial model in Excel with dynamic assumptions, scenario analysis, and professional formatting standards.



Navigate the IB World

Understand the organizational structure of investment banks, the types of deals they do, and how an analyst fits into the deal team.



Apply Corporate Finance Logic

Use NPV, IRR, WACC, and capital structure concepts to evaluate real business decisions — not just solve textbook problems.

- ✓ Phase 1 Mini Project: Analyze a public company's 10-K, normalize its financials, and build a simple 3-statement model — presented in a 1-page investment memo format.

Intermediate Phase: Valuation & Deal Mechanics

This is the technical core of investment banking. You'll master the three primary valuation methodologies used on every deal, learn how M&A transactions are structured, and develop the analytical instincts that distinguish strong analysts from average ones.

1

Week 5: Comparable Company Analysis (Comps)

- Selecting the right peer group — industry, size, geography
- Key trading multiples: EV/EBITDA, P/E, EV/Revenue
- Scrubbing financials for comparability (NTM vs. LTM)
- Building a comps table in Excel from SEC filings
- Interpreting the spread: premium vs. discount analysis
- Exercise: Comp set analysis for a real sector (e.g., SaaS or Healthcare)

2

Week 6: Precedent Transactions Analysis

- Transaction vs. trading multiples — why the premium exists
- Sourcing deal data: Bloomberg, PitchBook, Mergermarket
- Control premium and synergy-adjusted multiples
- Building a transaction comps table
- How to read deal announcements and press releases
- Exercise: Screen 10 deals and build a transaction comps table

3

Week 7: Discounted Cash Flow (DCF) Valuation

- Projecting revenue, margins, capex, and working capital
- Calculating WACC: beta, risk-free rate, equity risk premium
- Terminal value: Gordon Growth vs. Exit Multiple method
- Sensitivity analysis: WACC vs. growth rate football field
- Common DCF mistakes and how interviewers test them
- Assignment: Full DCF model for a publicly traded company

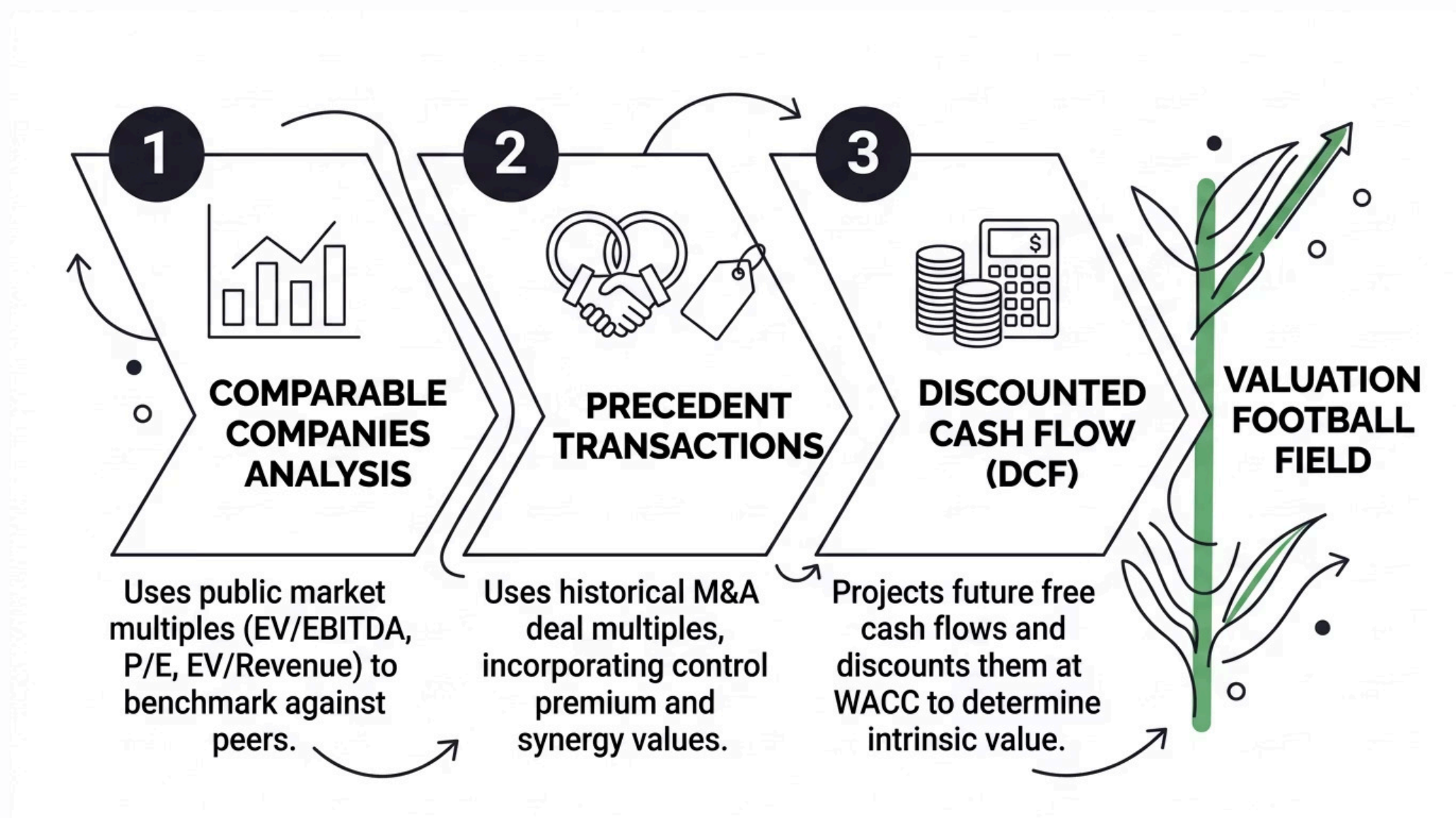
4

Week 8: M&A Fundamentals & Deal Structure

- Strategic rationale: synergies, diversification, market share
- Buy-side vs. sell-side mandates and process flow
- Stock vs. cash deals — EPS accretion/dilution analysis
- Deal timeline: LOI → due diligence → definitive agreement → close
- Introduction to merger models (accretion/dilution framework)
- Case study: Analyze a recent announced merger and identify the strategic rationale

The Three Pillars of Investment Banking Valuation

Every valuation in investment banking is anchored by three methodologies. Together, they form the "football field" — a range of values that helps buyers, sellers, and advisors negotiate with confidence. Understanding when and how to use each is a core analyst skill.



i In practice, no single method is used in isolation. Bankers triangulate across all three to build a defensible valuation range — and each method serves as a check on the others.

Advanced Phase: Deals, Markets & Client Delivery

In the final core phase, you move from analysis to execution. You'll learn how capital markets work, how to build a leveraged buyout model, how equity offerings are structured, and – critically – how to communicate all of this in a pitch book that wins mandates.

1

Week 9: Leveraged Buyout (LBO) Modeling

- LBO mechanics: how private equity creates returns
- Sources and uses of funds; debt schedule and tranches
- IRR and MOIC: what PE sponsors look for
- Operating model integration into LBO structure
- Key drivers: entry multiple, exit multiple, leverage, margin expansion
- Assignment: Build a paper LBO and then a full Excel LBO model

2

Week 10: Equity Capital Markets (ECM) & IPO Process

- IPO vs. follow-on offerings vs. convertible notes
- The IPO process: S-1 filing, roadshow, bookbuilding, pricing
- Roles of the lead left, co-managers, and syndicate
- Valuation for pre-revenue and growth companies
- SPAC vs. traditional IPO – structural differences
- Case: Dissect a recent tech IPO – valuation, pricing, and performance

3

Week 11: Debt Capital Markets (DCM) & Leveraged Finance

- Investment grade vs. high-yield bonds – ratings and spreads
- Syndicated loans, revolving credit facilities, and term loans
- Covenant analysis and credit agreement key terms
- Pricing a bond: yield, duration, and credit spread
- DCM deal process and roles of issuer, bank, and investor
- Exercise: Analyze a bond offering and evaluate credit risk

4

Week 12: Pitch Books & Client Communication

- Anatomy of an investment banking pitch book
- Executive summary, situation overview, and valuation pages
- Design principles: slide structure, charts, and formatting in PowerPoint
- Delivering the pitch: what MDs look for in junior bankers
- Writing the investment thesis: concise, defensible, compelling
- Assignment: Create a 15-slide pitch book for a mock M&A deal

Capstone Project: Live Deal Simulation

The capstone is a 3–4 week end-to-end deal simulation designed to mirror what an actual analyst experiences on a live transaction. You'll work in small teams, advised by a mentor, and present your final deliverable to a mock deal committee.

Capstone Deliverables

- **Week 13:** Company selection, industry overview, and financial model (comps, DCF, LBO)
- **Week 14:** Deal structuring — M&A, ECM, or DCM scenario chosen by the team
- **Week 15:** Full pitch book construction — 20–25 slides with valuation, rationale, and deal terms
- **Week 16:** Final presentation to a mock deal committee of mentors and industry reviewers

Evaluation Criteria

- Financial model accuracy and defensibility
- Quality of the investment thesis and narrative
- Pitch book design and professional presentation
- Ability to handle Q&A under pressure

What Makes a Strong Capstone

The best capstone projects treat the simulation as a real deal. Strong teams choose companies with a clear strategic narrative, model conservatively, and build pitch books that a Managing Director would be proud to walk into a boardroom with.

Mentors provide two rounds of feedback — one mid-process and one on the final draft — ensuring every learner finishes with a portfolio-quality deliverable.

Industry Example #1

Microsoft's \$69B Acquisition of Activision Blizzard

This landmark technology M&A deal — the largest in gaming history — illustrates how investment bankers structure, value, and defend a complex acquisition to regulators, shareholders, and the market.

The Business Problem

Microsoft needed to accelerate its gaming content library and subscriber base to compete with Sony's PlayStation ecosystem. Organic growth alone could not close the gap — a transformational acquisition was required.

How Course Concepts Apply

Bankers built a full merger model to assess EPS accretion/dilution. DCF and comps were used to justify the \$95/share offer price. Synergy analysis quantified \$3B+ in cost and revenue synergies over 3 years.

Tools Used

Excel (merger model, synergy waterfall), Bloomberg (market data, comps), PowerPoint (pitch book), and regulatory filings for due diligence review.

Role of Early Professionals

Junior analysts built and maintained the financial model, drafted the comparable companies table, formatted pitch book slides, and prepared talking points for partner meetings with regulators — logging 80+ hour weeks during peak diligence.

Industry Example #2

ARM Holdings IPO: Pricing a Semiconductor Giant

ARM's September 2023 IPO on Nasdaq — one of the largest tech listings in years — demonstrates how ECM bankers value and position a complex, high-profile offering for institutional investors.

The Business Problem

SoftBank needed to monetize its stake in ARM while maximizing proceeds and investor confidence after a volatile market environment for tech IPOs. Setting the right price required balancing demand signals from the roadshow against long-term valuation credibility.

How Concepts Apply

- Pre-revenue growth valuation using EV/Revenue and forward P/E multiples
- Comparable company analysis vs. semiconductor and IP licensing peers
- Bookbuilding process: gauging demand across 100+ institutional accounts
- S-1 filing review and financial model construction

Measurable Impact

ARM priced at **\$51/share**, raising **\$4.87B** at a ~\$54B market cap. The stock surged 25% on Day 1, validating the pricing strategy. The deal restored institutional appetite for large tech IPOs — paving the way for other listings in the pipeline.

Role of Junior Analysts

- Built and maintained the IPO valuation model
- Prepared investor presentation slides and roadshow materials
- Tracked real-time order book data during bookbuilding
- Drafted the comparable companies section of the prospectus

Industry Example #3

Private Equity Buyout: Vista Equity's Take-Private of Citrix

This \$16.5B leveraged buyout — one of the largest software take-privates ever — brings the LBO model to life and shows how debt markets, financial engineering, and strategic vision intersect in a single deal.



Identify the Target

Citrix: mature SaaS revenues, predictable cash flows, and a depressed public market valuation — ideal LBO candidate.



Structure the Deal

\$8.55B in leveraged loans + \$4B in unsecured bonds. Equity check of ~\$4B. Debt/EBITDA leverage at ~8x — aggressive but serviceable.



Value Creation Plan

Operational improvements, margin expansion, and potential re-IPO or strategic sale at a higher exit multiple within 5–7 years.



LBO Model Output

Base case: ~20% IRR and 2.2x MOIC over a 5-year hold — driven by FCF generation and debt paydown rather than multiple expansion.

Junior bankers on this deal spent weeks building the debt schedule, stress-testing downside scenarios, and preparing lender presentations for the syndicated loan roadshow — all core skills taught in Weeks 9 and 11 of this course.

The Investment Banking Technology Stack

Investment bankers operate with a specific set of tools that vary by deal type and seniority. Proficiency in this stack is expected from Day 1 as a full-time analyst. This course introduces and applies each tool in context.



Microsoft Excel

The core modeling environment. Used for 3-statement models, DCF, LBO, merger models, and sensitivity analysis. Mastery is non-negotiable.



Microsoft PowerPoint

The pitch book and client communication tool. Every deal deliverable – from CIM to management presentation – lives here.



Bloomberg Terminal

Real-time market data, trading multiples, bond pricing, and news. Used for comps, DCM analysis, and macro research.



PitchBook / Capital IQ

Deal databases for sourcing precedent transactions, private company financials, and investor ownership data.



SEC EDGAR

Primary source for public company filings – 10-K, 10-Q, S-1, 8-K. Every financial model starts here.



Mergermarket / Refinitiv

Deal intelligence, league table data, and M&A news for sourcing transaction comps and market context.

Job Roles & Skills Mapped to This Course

This program is designed to make you interview-ready and analyst-ready simultaneously. The skills you build here map directly to the roles that hire aggressively from programs like this one.

Job Role	Beginner Skills	Intermediate Skills	Job-Ready Skills
IB Analyst (Bulge Bracket)	3-Statement model, Excel, accounting	DCF, comps, pitch book formatting	LBO model, merger model, live deal support
M&A Associate	Financial statements, WACC, NPV	Accretion/dilution, deal structuring	End-to-end deal management, client interaction
ECM / DCM Analyst	Capital markets basics, bond math	IPO valuation, credit analysis	Bookbuilding, roadshow prep, pricing
PE / Growth Equity Analyst	LBO logic, leverage concepts	IRR/MOIC, operating model	Full LBO model, investment memo, IC presentation
Corporate Development Analyst	Strategic rationale, M&A basics	Synergy analysis, target screening	Buy-side process, integration planning, NDA/LOI review

Your Path from Learner to Investment Banker



Month 1: Build the Foundation

Master financial statements, Excel modeling, and corporate finance principles.



Month 2: Master Valuation

Execute comps, precedent transactions, and DCF with real data and live models.



Month 3: Execute Like a Banker

Build LBO models, analyze ECM/DCM deals, and construct a professional pitch book.



Month 4: Deliver the Capstone

Complete a full deal simulation and present to a mock deal committee – portfolio-ready.

- ❏ After completing this course, the recommended next steps are: target analyst recruiting cycles (BB, EB, or boutique), apply to spring week / summer internship programs, network with alumni on LinkedIn using the cold outreach frameworks taught in Week 1, and continue sharpening models using publicly available deal filings. The tools, frameworks, and instincts you build here are exactly what hiring managers are testing for.